

MONEY MUSE AI

The Debt Freedom Tracker

A clear, visual system to pay off debt faster — without
pretending it isn't stressful to look at.

*"You don't need to feel motivated every day. You need
a method that works even on the days you don't."*

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Two Methods, One Decision

Read this first

There are two well-tested ways to pay off multiple debts: the snowball (smallest balance first, for momentum) and the avalanche (highest interest rate first, for math efficiency). Neither is objectively "correct" — the right one is whichever you'll actually stick with. This tracker supports either.

Method	Order	Best if...
Snowball	Smallest balance to largest	You need visible wins to stay motivated
Avalanche	Highest interest rate to lowest	You're motivated by saving the most money overall

Your Method

Which one matches how you actually stay motivated — not which one sounds more responsible?

List Every Debt

All of it, even the uncomfortable ones

Debt	Balance	Interest rate	Minimum payment

Total Debt

Add every balance above. Write the total here, plainly, without spiraling on it.

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Order Your Payoff Plan

Based on your method from the welcome page

Order	Debt	Balance	Extra payment goal
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Pay minimums on everything except your #1 debt. Every extra dollar goes there until it's gone — then roll that whole payment into #2, and so on.

Monthly Payoff Tracker

Watch the number move – that’s the whole game

Month	Total debt remaining	Amount paid this month
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		

Finding Extra Payment Money

- ☐ One subscription cancelled and redirected to debt
- ☐ One "no-spend" week a month
- ☐ Any windfall (bonus, refund, gift) goes straight to the #1 debt
- ☐ A side income stream, even small, redirected entirely to payoff

Staying Motivated Mid-Payoff

The middle is always the hardest part

AI companion prompt: "I'm paying off debt using the [snowball/avalanche] method. I've paid off [amount] so far and have [amount] left. Write me a short, honest note of encouragement that doesn't feel cheesy — acknowledge the real effort this takes."

Celebrate the Milestones

Pick a small, free or low-cost way to mark each debt paid off completely — not as a reward that undoes progress, but as an acknowledgment that this is genuinely hard and you did it.

If You Have to Pause the Plan

Life happens — a pause isn't a failure

An emergency, a job change, or an unexpected expense might mean you have to drop back to minimum payments for a while. That's not falling off the plan — it's the plan working exactly as it should to protect you. Resume extra payments as soon as you're able, starting from wherever you left off.

THE NUMBER IS MOVING

Every Payment Is Proof, Not Just Progress

Debt freedom isn't one big moment — it's a hundred small decisions that added up. Keep tracking.

Continue with the Savings Goal Planner once your debt payoff has room to breathe.